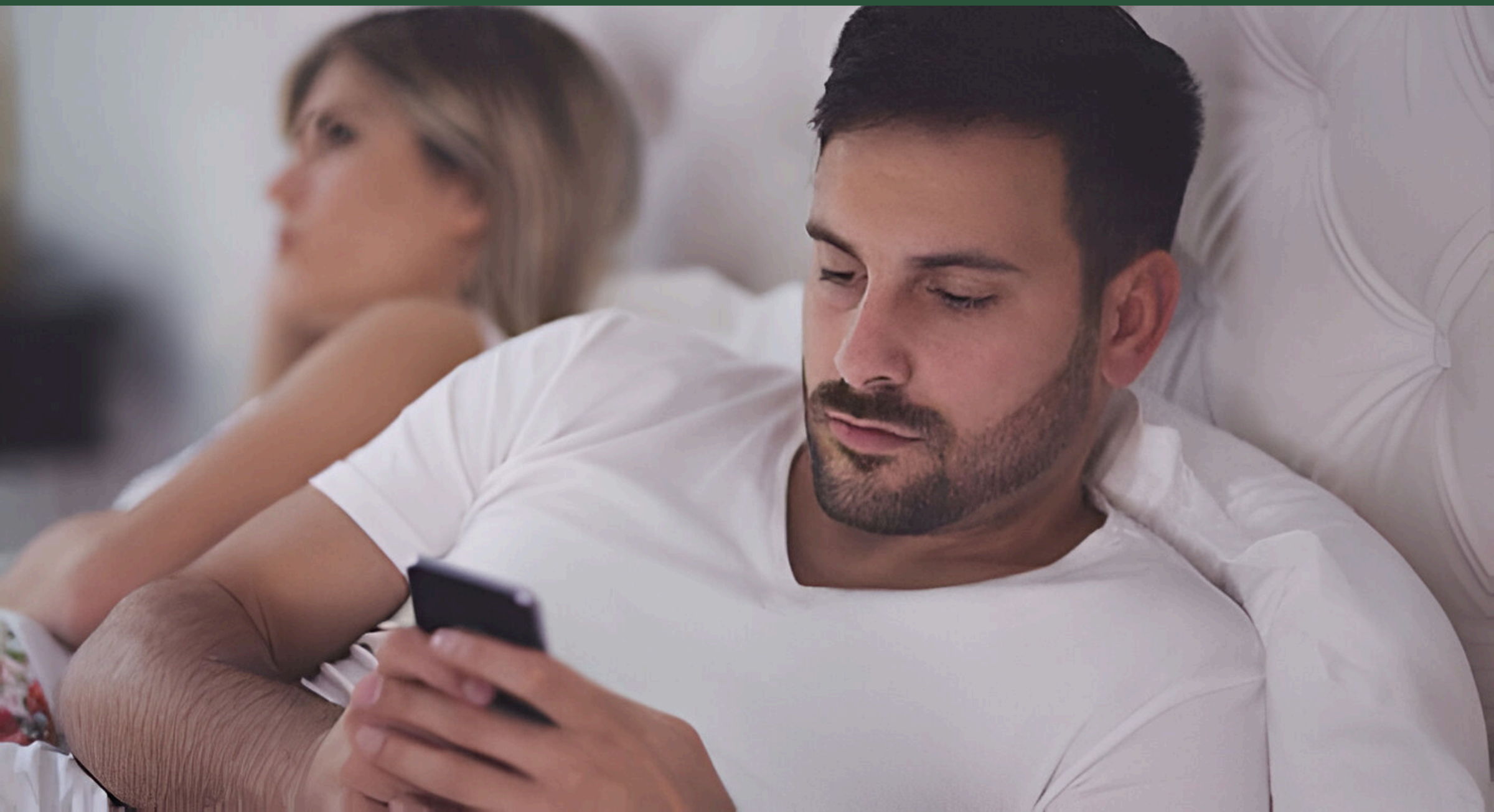


Her: He's probably texting other girls



Decision Tables vs If statements in ServiceNow

Ah, decision tables vs if statements in ServiceNow - a classic showdown! It's like choosing between a well-organized filing cabinet and a frantic game of "Where's Waldo?" in your code. Decision tables strut around like the cool kids, bragging about their readability and maintainability, while if statements huddle in dark corners, whispering, "But I'm faster!" to anyone who'll listen. In the end, it's all about whether you prefer your logic neat and tidy or enjoy the thrill of hunting down that elusive else clause at 3 AM.

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Simplifying Flow Designer with Decision Tables

Purpose of Decision Tables

Decision Input	Input field	Decisions						
Demo task	Cost	< \$1000	\$1k-\$5k	\$1k-\$5k	\$5k-\$25k	\$5k-\$25k	>\$25k	>\$25k
	Item Type	Hardware	Hardware	Hardware	Hardware	Hardware	Hardware	Hardware
	Stock Available	Yes or No	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
Results								
		Manager	Manager	Director	Director	VP	VP	CxO

Decision Tables in ServiceNow simplify complex business logic by presenting rules in an easy-to-understand tabular format.

The Power Duo

Combine Flow Designer's automation capabilities with Decision Tables' complex logic handling.

Decision Tables simplify complex branching logic in flows. They reduce the need for multiple decision elements, making flows cleaner and more maintainable.



The Power Duo

Decision Inputs (3) Decisions (5)

Decisions New Search Order ▼ Search 1 to 5 of 5

Decision table = Approval Policy

	Label	Answer	Order ▲
☐	<u>Manager approval - cost threshold</u>	Approval Level: Manager	100
☐	<u>Manager approval - available stock</u>	Approval Level: Manager	125
☐	<u>Director approval</u>	Approval Level: Director	200
☐	<u>VP approval</u>	Approval Level: VP	300
☐	<u>CxO approval</u>	Approval Level: CxO	400

☐ Actions on selected rows...

Configure approval based on policy

Manager

Director

VP

CxO

Integrating Decision Table into Flow Designer

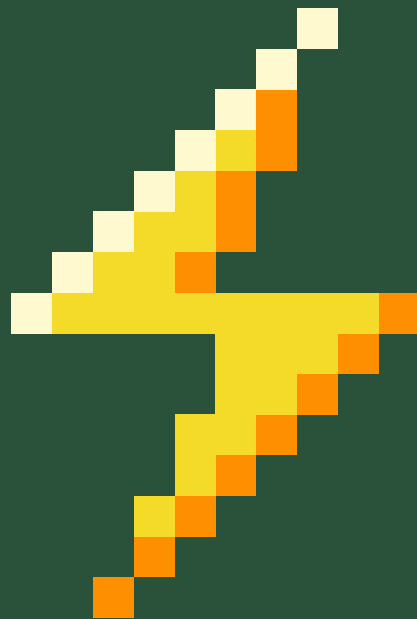
1. Add a "Decision Table" action to your flow
2. Configure the Decision Table:
 - Set input variables
 - Define output variables
 - Create decision rules
3. Connect the Decision Table to other flow elements
4. Test and activate your flow

Best Practice: Modular Design



Create reusable Decision Tables, if possible. Design them to be pluggable into multiple flows for maximum efficiency.

Best Practice: Performance



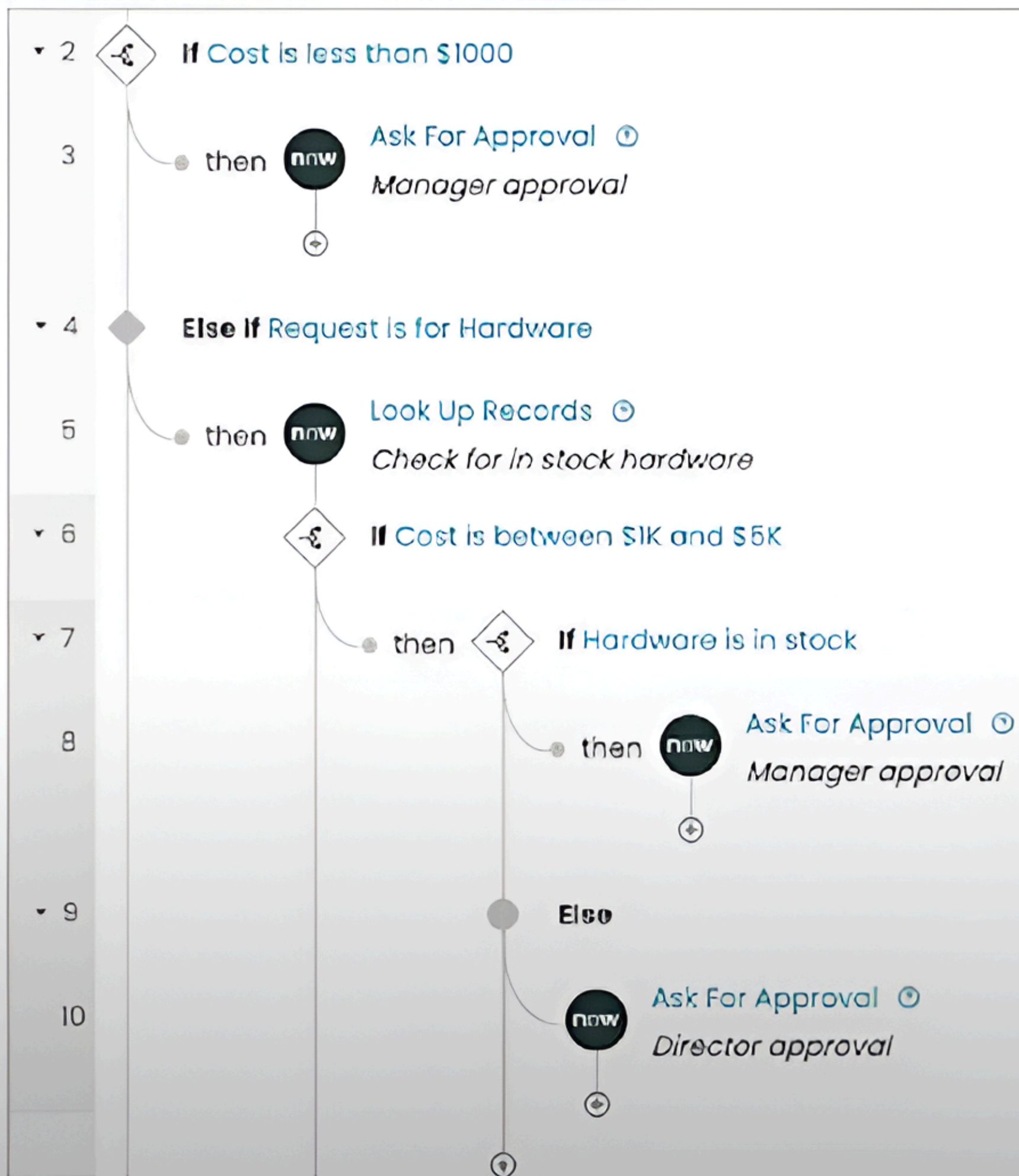
Decision Tables are evaluated in order. Place the most common scenarios at the top of the table for optimal performance.

Best Practice: Single Purpose



Keep Decision Tables focused on a single purpose. Break complex decisions into multiple tables for better maintainability.

Before



After



Benefits



Visibility

Makes flows cleaner and easier to understand visually



Better Collaboration

Empowers business users to modify decision logic without IT intervention



Improved Performance

Can handle complex decisions more efficiently than multiple branching elements

Benefits



Reduced Error Potential

Minimizes the risk of logic errors common
in complex scripted conditions



Increased Agility

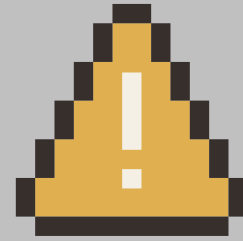
Enables quick adjustments to decision
criteria without flow redesign



Easier Debugging

Centralizes decision logic for easier
troubleshooting

Watch out



Avoid over-engineering



For simpler logic, standard "if" statements remain the preferred choice due to their straightforward implementation and readability.

Bonus



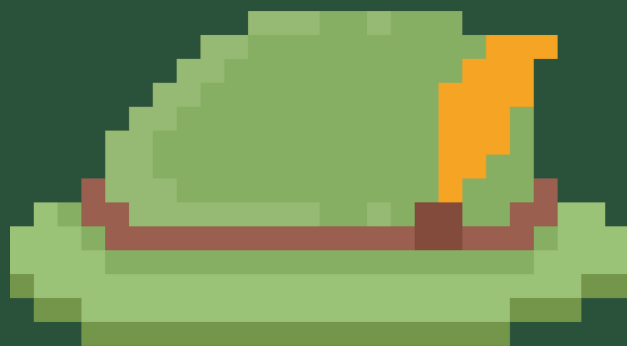
Decision Tables aren't just for Flow
Designer!

You can use them in Business Rules too.
Just leverage the `DecisionTableAPI` to
evaluate your tables right in your scripts.
It's a neat trick for keeping your Business
Rules clean and your logic centralized.
Give it a try next time you're juggling
complex conditions!

Conclusion

Decision Tables in Flow Designer are a game-changer for handling complex logic without cluttering your flows.

Give them a shot in your next project – you'll thank them later when you're not drowning in a sea of decision shapes!



Thanks,
Krystian